

Ocean giants

Whales and dolphins look like fish but they are actually mammals. The whale family includes some of the biggest creatures on earth.



The big blue

The blue whale is the largest animal in the world – its heart is the size of a small car. The next largest creature, a bull African elephant, could sit on its tongue!



Turn and learn

Water mammals:

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Plankton:

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Toothed whales

There are two kinds of whales – toothed whales and baleen whales. Toothed whales eat fish and large animals, such as seals. The killer whale can even leap onto beaches to grab unfortunate seals.



Baleen whales

Some whales, such as this humpback whale, have rows of filters called plates, instead of teeth. These are called baleen whales. They gulp huge amounts of water, then sieve it through the plates to remove the food – tiny animals called plankton.